

Chen (Cassie) Zhang

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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of California, Irvine (GPA: 3.91/4.00) Expected June 2027
M.A. in Econometrics and Quantitative Economics, University of California, Irvine (GPA: 3.81/4.00) December 2023
M.A. in International Comparative Education, Stanford University (GPA: 3.90/4.00) September 2020
Ignite Program, Graduate School of Business, Stanford University March 2020
B.A. in Economics and B.A. in International Studies (Double Major), UC Irvine (GPA: 3.83/4.00) March 2017
Magna Cum Laude, Phi Beta Kappa

Research Fields

Empirical Industrial Organization, Transportation Economics, Applied Microeconomics, Causal Inference, Energy Economics

Publications

Chen, Zhang “Competition and Consumer Welfare in Airline Markets: Evidence from the Alaska–Hawaiian Merger.” *Revised and resubmitted to the Journal of Air Transport Management*, 2026.

Chen Zhang (2026). “Determinants of Electric Vehicle Purchasing Decisions: Implications for Government Policies.” *Energy Sources, Part B: Economics, Planning, and Policy*, 21. [\[Link\]](#)

Working Papers

“Beyond Fares: Multimarket Contact and Capacity Discipline in Airline Markets” (Job Market Paper)
“AI and the Labor Bubble: A General Equilibrium Theory of the Rise and Fall of Mass Employment” (with Jiawei Chen)
“Merging to Challenge the Market Leader: An Empirical Analysis in the Sports Drink Industry”

Work in Progress

“Behavioral and Fiscal Impacts of Vehicle Weight Fees in California” (with David Brownstone, David Bunch and Jiawei Chen)

Conference Presentations

53rd European Association for Research in Industrial Economics (EARIE) Conference, <i>Presenter</i>	Aug 2026
42nd European Economics Association (EEA) Annual Conference, <i>Presenter</i>	Aug 2026
The 29th Air Transport Research Society (ATRS) World Conference, <i>Presenter</i>	Jul 2026
2026 Chinese Economists Society (CES) Annual Conference, <i>Session Chair, Presenter</i>	Jul 2026
Southern Economic Association 95th Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL, <i>Presenter</i>	Nov 2025
Western Economic Association International 100th Annual Conference, San Francisco, CA, <i>Presenter</i>	Jun 2025
Asia-Pacific Industrial Organization Conference (APIOC), Seoul, Korea, <i>Co-Presenter</i>	Dec 2024
Southern Economic Association 94th Annual Meeting, Washington, DC, <i>Presenter</i>	Nov 2024
International Conference on Empirical Economics, Penn State, <i>Presenter, Session Chair</i>	Aug 2024
2024 CES China Annual Conference, Zhejiang University, <i>Presenter, Session Chair</i>	Jul 2024
Conference of Comparative and International Education Society, Miami, FL, <i>Presenter, Chair</i>	Mar 2020

Teaching Experience

CSU Pre-Professor Program (PREPP), UC Irvine 2026–Present
Liaison School: California State University, East Bay
Summer Instructor, UC Irvine 2025; 2026
Probability Theory, Statistical Inference, and Econometrics (Undergraduate course)
California Community College Internship Program(CCCIP), Santa Ana College Jun 2025–Jun 2026
Microeconomic Theory
AI Writing & Digital Literacy Fellows Program 2025–Present
Faculty Learning Community of instructors from UC Irvine, Cal State Fullerton, and the North Orange County Community College District
Graduate Scholar, Division of Teaching Excellence & Innovation (DTEI), UC Irvine 2025; 2026
Graduate Instructor, UC Irvine Jan–Apr 2024
Instrumental Variables and Nonparametric Regression (PhD level)
Teaching Assistant, UC Irvine Sep 2022–Sep 2024

Applied Econometrics II; Intermediate Quantitative Econometrics I; Graduate Micro Econometrics and Public Policy; Probability and Statistics II; Corporate Finance; Behavioral Economics

Professional Experience

Graduate Student Researcher , UC Irvine	Sep 2024–Present
- Secured \$450k in competitive research funding by co-authoring grant proposals for the California Transportation Commission and the Pacific Southwest Region (PSR) University Transportation Center. - Lead researcher on multi-agency transportation initiatives; developed nested logit, BLP, and simulation models for EV adoption and vehicle weight-fee policy analysis.	
Transit Researcher Intern , California Air Resources Board	Mar–Jun 2025
- Designed quantitative GHG evaluation frameworks for \$10B+ in TIRCP-funded transit projects. - Developed statistical prediction methods for emissions reduction and ridership at the funding stage.	
Program Director , Education Without Barriers	Aug 2020–Sep 2021
Designed curricula for 1,000+ children in rural China and Kenya; conducted quasi-experimental impact evaluation.	
Operations Intern , Hospitality Systems Consultants Inc. (Stanford SEED)	Jun–Aug 2020

Awards and Fellowships

2026 ATRS Best Student Paper Award, Shortlisted — “Beyond Fares: Multimarket Contact and Capacity Discipline in Airline Markets”	2026
Otto W. Shaler Scholarship (\$11,500)	2025
Ken Small Award	2025
DECADE Professional Development Awards	2025
UC Irvine Summer Research Fellowship	2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
Long US-China Institute Graduate Student Research Fellowship	2024
European Association for Research in Industrial Economics (EARIE) Summer School	2024
NABE Full Scholarship for Economic Measurement Seminar	2023
UC Irvine Social Sciences Merit Fellowship	2021
UREAG Travel Grant Recipient	2020

Skills

Programming: Python, MATLAB, R, Stata, SQLite, JMP

Tools: PyBLP, dask, numpy, matplotlib, NVivo, L^AT_EX

Methods: Structural Estimation (BLP), Causal Inference (DID, Synthetic Control, IV), Discrete Choice Models, Counterfactual Simulation

Certifications

Foundation for Data Science (Stanford) · Business Analytics Specialization (UPenn, Coursera) · Economic Measurement (NABE)

Professional Service

Session Chair: CES Annual Conference (2024, 2026), International Conference on Empirical Economics (2024), CIES (2020)